

module-10-herbs-aushadhi - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - senior band

Module 10 — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Auṣadhi* · **Band:** Senior (9-12) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Six kitchen-and-garden healing plants.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 10's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Project Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1: “*There is no plant in the world that is not medicine.*” Pair with a modern phytochemistry paper title from *Journal of Ethnopharmacology*. “*Today: six well-studied Āyurveda herbs with their traditional uses, modern active compounds, AND honest safety warnings.*”

Core idea · 15 min

Six Āyurveda herbs — traditional uses + modern pharmacology + safety.

Sanskrit	Species	Active compound	Modern evidence
Tulasī	<i>Ocimum tenuiflorum</i>	Eugenol	Adaptogenic claims partially supported; clinical evidence moderate
Nimba	<i>Azadirachta indica</i>	Azadirachtin	Strong antimicrobial; HEPATOTOXIC at high oral doses
Haridrā	<i>Curcuma longa</i>	Curcumin	Anti-inflammatory supported; bioavailability poor without piperine
Ārdraka	<i>Zingiber officinale</i>	Gingerol	Anti-nausea well-supported (clinical trials)
Yavānī	<i>Trachyspermum ammi</i>	Thymol	Carminative effect; thymol antimicrobial
Pudīnā	<i>Mentha</i> spp.	Menthol	Mild GI relaxant; topical

Sanskrit	Species	Active compound	Modern evidence
			analgesic

Critical safety: therapeutic dosing belongs to qualified practitioners. Self-prescription based on Sanskrit names alone is dangerous. **Always consult a doctor.**

Demonstration · 10 min

Source comparison. Distribute one page of Caraka *Sūtrasthāna* 1 (on herbs) + one abstract of a modern phytochemistry review for turmeric/curcumin. Compare: claims, evidence, framing. Where do they agree? Diverge?

Source moment · 5 min

Direct verse. Atharva Veda 8.7.4:

yā oṣadhīr pūrvā jātā devebhyas tri-yugaṁ purā

“The herbs that were born before the gods, by three ages.”

The verse establishes the antiquity-claim for herbal medicine in the Indian tradition. Modern: phylogenetic evidence supports that flowering plants predate human evolution by ~100 million years. The poetic claim has empirical resonance.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Critical-pharmacology project pitch. Each student picks ONE of the 6 herbs and proposes a 1-page research summary: traditional use, active compound, modern clinical evidence (or absence), safety profile. Pitch to class for critique.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“What’s the right way to teach Āyurveda herbs in modern schools? Where’s the line between cultural literacy and medical recommendation?”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — What is auṣadhi?
- **Day 02** — Tulsī — holy basil

- **Day 03** — Neem — bitter healer
- **Day 04** — Turmeric — golden root
- **Day 05** — Ginger — warming root
- **Day 06** — Ajwain — carom seed
- **Day 07** — Mint — cooling leaf
- **Day 08** — Herbs and the doṣas (link to Module 4)
- **Day 09** — Build the class herb deck
- **Day 10** — Final share + assessment

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.